

OverTheWire Bandit: Level 0 -> 15 Walkthrough

Level 0 → Level 1

Login Credentials

Username: bandit0

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: bandit0

Objective

To connect to the OverTheWire Bandit server and read the password stored in the readme file.

Procedure

1. Open the terminal.
2. Connect to the Bandit server using SSH with the given credentials.
3. List the files in the current directory.
4. Identify the readme file.
5. Read the contents of the readme file to obtain the password for Level 1.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit0@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

-To connect to the Bandit server using SSH on port 2220.

ls

-To list the files and directories in the current directory.

cat readme

-To display the contents of the readme file and obtain the password for Level 1.

```
PS C:\Users\acer\Desktop> ssh bandit0@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220
```

bandit0

This is an OverTheWire game server.
More information on <http://www.overthewire.org/wargames>

backend: gibson-0

bandit0@bandit.labs.overthewire.org's password:

OverTheWire

www. ver he " ire.org

Welcome to OverTheWire!

```
bandit0@bandit:~$ ls
```

```
readme
```

```
bandit0@bandit:~$ cat readme
```

Congratulations on your first steps into the bandit game!!

Please make sure you have read the rules at <https://overthewire.org/rules/>

If you are following a course, workshop, walkthrough or other educational activity, please inform the instructor about the rules as well and encourage them to contribute to the OverTheWire community so we can keep these games free!

The password you are looking for is: 6y2kwnwK6grgvwvpvLaa2T1cpFEK0hNR

```
bandit0@bandit:~$ |
```

Level 1 → Level 2

Login Credentials

Username: bandit1

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: Obtained from Level 0

Objective

To read the password stored in a file named "-".

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server using the bandit1 account.
2. List the files and identify the file named "-".
3. Use "./" before the filename so that "-" is treated as a file.
4. Read the contents of the file to obtain the password for Level 2.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit1@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server using SSH.

ls

To list the files and directories in the current directory.

cat ./-

To display the contents of the file named "-". "./" tells the terminal that "-" is a file in the current directory.

```
bandit0@bandit:~$ exit
logout
Connection to bandit.labs.overthewire.org closed.
PS C:\Users\acer\Desktop> ssh bandit1@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220
```

bandit

This is an OverTheWire game server.
More information on <http://www.overthewire.org/wargames>

```
backend: gibbon-0
bandit1@bandit.labs.overthewire.org's password:
```

OverTheWire

www. ver he ire.org

Welcome to OverTheWire!

```
bandit1@bandit:~$ ls
-
bandit1@bandit:~$ cat ./-
PK8fYLZg2hnHSz83pLbL1iEPKdD3QT0B
bandit1@bandit:~$
```

Level 2 → Level 3

Login Credentials

Username: bandit2
Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org
Port: 2220
Password: Obtained from Level 1

Objective

To read the password from a file whose name contains spaces.

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server using the bandit2 account.
2. List the files and identify the file with spaces in its name.
3. Use double quotes around the filename so that the entire text is treated as one filename.
4. Read the contents of the file to obtain the password for Level 3.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit2@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server using SSH.

ls

To list the files and directories in the current directory.

cat "--spaces in this filename--"

To display the contents of the file. Double quotes indicate that the entire text is the name of one file.

```
bandit2@bandit:~$ ls
--spaces in this filename--
bandit2@bandit:~$ cat "--spaces in this filename--"
7ZZ2LFrykP2zEyvBl4m3clL7tGYJPME
bandit2@bandit:~$
```

Level 3 → Level 4

Login Credentials

Username: bandit3

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: Obtained from Level 2

Objective

To find and read the hidden file inside the inhere directory.

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server using the bandit3 account.
2. Move into the inhere directory.
3. List all files, including hidden files.
4. Identify the hidden file.
5. Read the contents of the hidden file to obtain the password for Level 4.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit3@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server using SSH.

cd inhere

To move into the inhere directory.

ls -la

To display all files, including hidden files.

cat "../../Hiding-From-You"

To display the contents of the hidden file and obtain the password for Level 4

```
bandit3@bandit:~$ ls
inhere
bandit3@bandit:~$ cd inhere
bandit3@bandit:~/inhere$ ls
bandit3@bandit:~/inhere$ ls -la
total 12
drwxr-xr-x 2 root    root    4096 Jun 24 14:59 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 root    root    4096 Jun 24 14:59 ..
-rw-r----- 1 bandit4 bandit3   33 Jun 24 14:59 ...Hiding-From-You
bandit3@bandit:~/inhere$ cat "../../Hiding-From-You"
xzTXqlrDJQVVAzdV5cHq1TQytTWufAMq
bandit3@bandit:~/inhere$ |
```

Level 4 → Level 5

Login Credentials

Username: bandit4

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: Obtained from Level 3

Objective

To find the only human-readable file among several files in the inhere directory.

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server using the bandit4 account.
2. Move into the inhere directory.
3. Check the type of each file.
4. Identify the file containing human-readable text.
5. Read the file to obtain the password for Level 5.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit4@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server using SSH.

cd inhere

To move into the inhere directory.

file ./-file*

To identify the type of all files whose names start with "-file".

cat ./maybehere07/.file2

To display the contents of the identified human-readable file and obtain the password for Level 5.

```
bandit4@bandit:~/inhere$ ls
-file00 -file01 -file02 -file03 -file04 -file05 -file06 -file07 -file08 -file09
bandit4@bandit:~/inhere$ file ./-file*
./-file00: data
./-file01: data
./-file02: data
./-file03: data
./-file04: data
./-file05: data
./-file06: OpenPGP Public Key
./-file07: ASCII text
./-file08: data
./-file09: Motorola S-Record; binary data in text format
bandit4@bandit:~/inhere$ cat ./-file07
6C7h9GD8M6ai5nr7wo1RonrzFjj9yIrG
bandit4@bandit:~/inhere$ |
```

Level 5 → Level 6

Login Credentials

Username: bandit5

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: Obtained from Level 4

Objective

To find a file with a specific size that is not executable.

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server using the bandit5 account.
2. Move into the inhere directory.
3. Search for a regular file with a size of 1033 bytes that is not executable.

4. Identify the required file from the search result.
5. Read the file to obtain the password for Level 6.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit5@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server using SSH.

cd inhere

To move into the inhere directory.

find . -type f -size 1033c ! -executable

To find a regular file that is exactly 1033 bytes in size and is not executable.

cat ./<file-path>

To display the contents of the identified file and obtain the password for Level 6.

```
bandit5@bandit:~$ ls
inhere
bandit5@bandit:~$ cd inhere
bandit5@bandit:~/inhere$ ls
maybehere00 maybehere02 maybehere04 maybehere06 maybehere08 maybehere10 maybehere12 maybehere14 maybehere16 maybehere18
maybehere01 maybehere03 maybehere05 maybehere07 maybehere09 maybehere11 maybehere13 maybehere15 maybehere17 maybehere19
bandit5@bandit:~/inhere$ find . -type f -size 1033c ! -executable
./maybehere07/.file2
bandit5@bandit:~/inhere$ cat ./maybehere07/.file2
pXa26xhMwaC2SvDotA4r9EgZkul0eSBW
```

Level 6 → Level 7

Login Credentials

Username: bandit6

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: Obtained from Level 5

Objective

To find a file owned by user bandit7, belonging to group bandit6, and having a size of 33 bytes.

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server using the bandit6 account.
2. Search the entire system for a file matching the given user, group, and size conditions.
3. Ignore the permission-denied error messages.
4. Read the identified file to obtain the password for Level 7.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit6@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server using SSH.

find / -user bandit7 -group bandit6 -size 33c 2>/dev/null

To search the entire system for a 33-byte file owned by bandit7 and belonging to the bandit6 group. **2>/dev/null** hides permission-denied error messages.

cat <file-path>

To display the contents of the identified file and obtain the password for Level 7.

```
bandit6@bandit:~$ ls
bandit6@bandit:~$ ls -la
total 20
drwxr-xr-x  2 root root 4096 Jun 24 14:58 .
drwxr-xr-x 150 root root 4096 Jun 24 15:02 ..
-rw-r--r--  1 root root  220 Feb 13  2026 .bash_logout
-rw-r--r--  1 root root 3851 Jun 24 14:50 .bashrc
-rw-r--r--  1 root root  807 Feb 13  2026 .profile
bandit6@bandit:~$ find / -user bandit7 -group bandit6 -size 33c 2>/dev/null
/var/lib/dpkg/info/bandit7.password
bandit6@bandit:~$ cat /var/lib/dpkg/info/bandit7.password
Bmnnvf82KzQLfxgAI2d1zYbr1u9pr3E3
bandit6@bandit:~$ |
```

Level 7 → Level 8

Login Credentials

Username: bandit7

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: Obtained from Level 6

Objective

To find the password stored in data.txt next to the word "millionth".

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server using the bandit7 account.
2. Locate the data.txt file.
3. Search the file for the word "millionth".
4. Read the corresponding password from the output.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit7@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server using SSH.

grep "millionth" data.txt

To search data.txt for the word "millionth" and display the matching line containing the password for Level 8.

```
bandit7@bandit:~$ ls
data.txt
bandit7@bandit:~$ grep "millionth" data.txt
millionth      VR1ljMayciFxbnUokuQmJFw6QC9VKtub
bandit7@bandit:~$ |
```

Level 8 → Level 9

Login Credentials

Username: bandit8

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: Obtained from Level 7

Objective

To find the only line in data.txt that occurs exactly once.

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server using the bandit8 account.
2. Locate the data.txt file.
3. Sort all the lines in the file.
4. Find the line that appears only once.
5. The unique line contains the password for Level 9.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit8@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server using SSH.

sort data.txt

To arrange all the lines in alphabetical order so that duplicate lines are placed together.

uniq -u

To display only the lines that occur once.

sort data.txt | uniq -u

To sort the file and then display the line that occurs only once.

```
bandit8@bandit:~$ ls
data.txt
bandit8@bandit:~$ sort data.txt | uniq -u
Ejm0SvuAu7sGAHqHVcBDPirRe9T03kxL
bandit8@bandit:~$ |
```

Level 9 → Level 10

Login Credentials

Username: bandit9

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: Obtained from Level 8

Objective

To find the password hidden among readable strings in the data.txt file.

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server using the bandit9 account.
2. Locate the data.txt file.
3. Extract the readable strings from the file.
4. Search the extracted strings for the relevant pattern.
5. Identify the password for Level 10.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit9@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server using SSH.

strings data.txt

To extract readable text from the binary data in the file.

grep "="

To search for lines containing the "=" character.

strings data.txt | grep "="

To extract readable strings and filter them to find the line containing the password.

```
bandit9@bandit:~$ ls
data.txt
bandit9@bandit:~$ strings data.txt | grep "="
=KGE
cL0===== the
=<P&
===== password
bU=\
a7=P
>===== is
wbp=
=LR(
a=-io
R===== B0s2khmbT9u0geKu0oVGW3JZKhndE3BG
)=Lc
x=E$
bandit9@bandit:~$ |
```

Level 10 → Level 11

Login Credentials

Username: bandit10

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: Obtained from Level 9

Objective

To decode the Base64-encoded contents of data.txt and obtain the password for Level 11.

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server using the bandit10 account.
2. Check the type of data.txt.
3. Decode the contents of the file using Base64 decoding.
4. The decoded output contains the password for Level 11.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit10@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server using SSH.

file data.txt

To identify the type of data stored in the file.

base64 -d data.txt

To decode the Base64-encoded contents of data.txt and display the password for Level 11.

```
Enjoy your stay!

bandit10@bandit:~$ ls
data.txt
bandit10@bandit:~$ file data.txt
data.txt: ASCII text
bandit10@bandit:~$ base64 -d data.txt
The password is pYfOY6HwUsDj5rL9UvyhU7MCmv8vN5Ro
bandit10@bandit:~$ |
```

Level 11 → Level 12

Login Credentials

Username: bandit11

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: Obtained from Level 10

Objective

To decode the password that has been encrypted using ROT13.

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server using the bandit11 account.
2. Locate the data.txt file.
3. Use the `tr` command to perform ROT13 substitution on the contents.
4. The decoded text contains the password for Level 12.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit11@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server using SSH.

file data.txt

To identify the type of data stored in the file.

tr 'A-Za-z' 'N-ZA-Mn-za-m' < data.txt

To replace each alphabetic character with its ROT13 equivalent and decode the contents of the file.

Enjoy your stay!

```
bandit11@bandit:~$ ls
data.txt
bandit11@bandit:~$ file data.txt
data.txt: ASCII text
bandit11@bandit:~$ tr 'A-Za-z' 'N-ZA-Mn-za-m' < data.txt
The password is GROozWPO8QyN0mGrjUKID0WCYkZiQxrN
bandit11@bandit:~$ |
```

Level 12 → 13

Login Credentials

Username: bandit12

Password: Obtained from previous level

Objective

Find the password hidden inside a file that has been repeatedly compressed and archived using different formats.

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server: **ssh bandit12@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220**
2. Create a temporary directory and move into it:

```
mktemp -d
```

```
cd /tmp/<temporary-directory>
```

3. Copy the **data.txt** file into the temporary directory:

```
cp ~/data.txt .
```

4. Convert the hexadecimal dump back into its original binary form:

```
xxd -r data.txt > data.bin
```

5. Identify the file type:

```
file data.bin
```

6. The file was gzip compressed, so rename and decompress it:

```
mv data.bin data.gz
gzip -d data.gz
```

7. Identify the resulting file:

```
file data
```

8. The file was bzip2 compressed, so rename and decompress it:

```
mv data data.bz2
bzip2 -d data.bz2
```

9. Identify the resulting file:

```
file data
```

10. The file was a tar archive, so extract it:

```
tar -xf data
```

11. Check the extracted file:

```
file data5.bin
```

12. It was another tar archive, so extract it:

```
tar -xf data5.bin
```

13. Check the next file:

```
file data6.bin
```

14. It was bzip2 compressed, so rename and decompress it:

```
mv data6.bin data6.bz2
bzip2 -d data6.bz2
```

15. Check the resulting file:

```
file data6
```

16. It was another tar archive, so extract it:

```
tar -xf data6
```

17. Check the next file:

file data8.bin

18. It was gzip compressed, so rename and decompress it:

mv data8.bin data8.gz

gzip -d data8.gz

19. Check the final file:

file data8

20. The file contained ASCII text, so display its contents:

cat data8

The output contained the password for Level 13.

Commands Used and Why?

- Creates a temporary directory.
- `cp mktmp -d` - Copies the challenge file to the temporary directory.
- `xxd -r` - Converts the hexadecimal dump back into binary data.
- `file` - Identifies the type of a file.
- `mv` - Renames the file with the appropriate extension.
- `gzip -d` - Decompresses a gzip file.
- `bzip2 -d` - Decompresses a bzip2 file.
- `tar -xf` - Extracts files from a tar archive.
- `cat` - Displays the contents of the final text file.

```

Enjoy your stay!

bandit12@bandit:~$ mkdir -p /tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ
bandit12@bandit:~$ cd /tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ cp ~/data.txt
cp: missing destination file operand after '/home/bandit12/data.txt'
Try 'cp --help' for more information.
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ cp ~/data.txt.
cp: missing destination file operand after '/home/bandit12/data.txt.'
Try 'cp --help' for more information.
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ cp ~/data.txt .
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ ls
data.txt
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ xxd -r data.txt > data.bin
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ file data.bin
data.bin: gzip compressed data, was "data2.bin", last modified: Wed Jun 24 14:58:58 2026, max compression, from Unix, original size modulo 2^32 578
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ mv data.bin data.gz
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ gzip -d data.gz
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ mv data data.bz2
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ bzip2 -d data.bz2
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ tar -xf data
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ ls
data data.txt data5.bin
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ file data5.bin
data5.bin: POSIX tar archive (GNU)
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ tar -xf data5.bin
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ ls
data data.txt data5.bin data6.bin
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ file data6.bin
data6.bin: bzip2 compressed data, block size = 900k
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ mv data6.bin data6.bz2
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ bzip2 -d data6.bz2
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ ls
data data.txt data5.bin data6
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ file data6
data6: POSIX tar archive (GNU)
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ tar -xf data6
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ ls
data data.txt data5.bin data6 data8.bin
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ file data8.bin
data8.bin: gzip compressed data, was "data9.bin", last modified: Wed Jun 24 14:58:58 2026, max compression, from Unix, original size modulo 2^32 49
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ mv data8.bin data8.gz
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ gzip -d data8.gz
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ file data8
data8: ASCII text
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ cat data8
The password is qQYQiHOBPR8zR6lqxYqX4S5quvihF2uzk
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/tmp.IwCrscWBIZ$ |

```

Level 13 → Level 14

Login Credentials

Username: bandit13

Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org

Port: 2220

Password: Obtained from Level 12

Objective

To use the private SSH key provided in the Level 13 account to log in as bandit14.

Procedure

1. Connect to the Bandit server as bandit13.
2. List the files and locate sshkey.private.
3. Exit the Bandit server.
4. Copy the private key to the local computer using SCP.
5. Use the private key to connect to bandit14.
6. Read the password file for bandit14.

Commands Used and Why?

ssh bandit13@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To connect to the Bandit server as bandit13.

ls

To locate the sshkey.private file.

exit

To leave the bandit13 session and return to the local terminal.

scp -P 2220 bandit13@bandit.labs.overthewire.org:sshkey.private .

To securely copy the private SSH key from the Bandit server to the local computer.

ssh -i sshkey.private bandit14@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220

To log in as bandit14 using the provided private SSH key.

cat /etc/bandit_pass/bandit14

To display the password for Level 14.

```
bandit13@bandit:~$ ls
HINT  sshkey.private
bandit13@bandit:~$ exit
logout
Connection to bandit.labs.overthewire.org closed.
PS C:\Users\acer\Desktop> scp -P 2220 bandit13@bandit.labs.overthewire.org:sshkey.private .
```

```

  _ _ _ _ _
 | | | | |
 | | | | |
 | | | | |
 | | | | |
  _ _ _ _ _
```

This is an OverTheWire game server.
More information on <http://www.overthewire.org/wargames>

```
backend: gibbon-0
bandit13@bandit.labs.overthewire.org's password:
sshkey.private                                100% 2602    1.8KB/s   00:01
PS C:\Users\acer\Desktop> ssh -i sshkey.private bandit14@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220
```

```

  _ _ _ _ _
 | | | | |
 | | | | |
 | | | | |
 | | | | |
  _ _ _ _ _
```

```
bandit14@bandit:~$ ls
bandit14@bandit:~$ ^C
bandit14@bandit:~$ cat /etc/bandit_pass/bandit14
aaWecNkG4FhxJQxz07uiwzVP6bJiYS65
bandit14@bandit:~$ |
```

Level 14 → Level 15

```
Username: bandit14
Host: bandit.labs.overthewire.org
Port: 2220
Password: Obtained from Level 13
```

To send the Level 14 password to a network service running on localhost port 30000 and obtain the password for Level 15.

1. Connect to the Bandit server as bandit14.
2. Use netcat to connect to the service running on localhost port 30000.
3. Enter the Level 14 password when prompted.
4. The service returns the password for Level 15.

ssh bandit14@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220
To connect to the Bandit server as bandit14.

To establish a connection to the network service running on port 30000 on the local Bandit server.

To authenticate with the service and obtain the password for Level 15.

[illegible]

```
bandit14@bandit:~$ nc localhost 30000  
aaWecNkG4FhxJQxz07uiwzVP6bJiYS65  
Correct!  
pbLYuZtTg4MgaqfJx8jbA9gKKGqM68A7
```